

What should I believe?

If you think about it, our initial question really breaks down into two sub-questions.

When should I form a
new belief?

When should I discard
one of my beliefs?

It is very natural to think that these questions should have general answers. Suppose, for example, that your friend typically forms beliefs about his future based on his horoscope. It seems plausible that he should not be forming beliefs in this way. But surely there is some general rule which explains **why** this is the case.

To have a name for them, let's call these general rules of belief.

Corresponding to our two questions will be two different kinds of belief.

Positive rules of belief will tell you
when you should form a certain
belief.

Negative rules of belief will tell you
when you should not have a certain
belief.

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